

SPECIAL TESTS — ANKLE & FOOT COMPLEX

I. TESTS FOR LIGAMENT STABILITY

1. ANTERIOR DRAWER TEST — ANKLE

PURPOSE

To assess the integrity of the anterior talofibular ligament (ATFL) and lateral ankle stability.

PROCEDURE

- Patient sits or lies supine.
- Keep the ankle in a neutral or slight plantar-flexed position.
- Stabilize the distal tibia with one hand.
- Grasp the heel/talus with the other hand.
- Draw the foot/talus anteriorly.

POSITIVE SIGN

- Excessive anterior translation compared with the opposite ankle.
- Soft/absent end-feel.
- Pain may be reproduced.

INDICATES

ATFL injury/lateral ankle instability.

2. TALAR TILT TEST

PURPOSE

To assess the integrity of the lateral ankle ligaments, particularly the calcaneofibular ligament (CFL).

PROCEDURE

- Patient sits or lies supine.
- Stabilize the distal leg.
- Grasp the calcaneus/heel.
- Tilt the calcaneus into inversion.

POSITIVE SIGN

- Excessive inversion compared with the opposite side.
- Pain or a soft end-feel.

INDICATES

CFL injury/lateral ankle instability.

II. TESTS FOR VASCULAR CONDITIONS — DVT

3. HOMAN'S TEST

PURPOSE

Traditionally used to assess for deep vein thrombosis (DVT) of the lower limb.

PROCEDURE

- Patient lies supine.
- Knee is extended.
- Examiner supports the leg.
- Passively dorsiflex the ankle.

POSITIVE SIGN

- Pain in the calf during passive ankle dorsiflexion.

INDICATES

Traditionally considered suggestive of DVT.

4. MOSES TEST

PURPOSE

Traditionally used to assess for DVT.

PROCEDURE

- Patient lies supine with the leg relaxed.
- Compress the calf anteroposteriorly.
- Then compress the calf laterally.

POSITIVE SIGN

- Pain produced by anteroposterior compression but not by lateral compression.

INDICATES

Traditionally considered suggestive of DVT.

REVISION TABLE

Category	Test	Positive Finding	Indicates
Ligament stability	Anterior Drawer	Excessive anterior translation	ATFL injury
Ligament stability	Talar Tilt	Excessive inversion	CFL injury
Vascular/DVT	Homan's	Calf pain on dorsiflexion	Traditionally DVT
Vascular/DVT	Moses	Pain with AP calf compression	Traditionally DVT